

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SATURDAY, 12 SEPTEMBER 2026

1 must-know stories, 1 Prelims facts, 6 editorials and 0 explainers, picked from 11 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Environment & Ecology

GS1 GS3

MAKE NOTES

New species of legless amphibian discovered from Maharashtra

The species named *Gegeneophis chandgadi* has been discovered by a multi-institutional team of researchers from the Kolhapur region (Chandgad) of the northern Western Ghats.

Where: Maharashtra, Western Ghats

Syllabus: GS1 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, Geography · Prelims angle: Species

[The Hindu: read the source](#)

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

JUDGMENT

QUICK READ

Supreme Court panel urged to halt transfer of Assam elephants to Tamil Nadu

Four captive elephants are in the process of being transferred, while a fifth, five-year-old Durga, has been moved to the Madurai Meenakshi Amman Temple...

[The Hindu: source](#)

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 More heft: On India and the 18th BRICS Summit

The BRICS Summit allows India to advance its global ambitions

[The Hindu](#)

GS2 The BRICS bank — an alternative that wasn't

BRICS promised a new financial order through the New Development Bank, but the truth is that it remains deeply tied to the old one

[The Hindu](#)

GS2 What China, Russia want & India wishes

The three strongmen in this breathless buildup share more contradictions than congruence. Each has a different worldview, as also a different adversary

[Business Standard](#)

GS2 A bigger BRICS, shaped by India's vision

BRICS, which is now too big to fail, confronts geopolitical turbulence while pursuing practical cooperation

[The Hindu](#)

GS3 Best of BS Opinion: Why AI should worry us more than nuclear weapons

Today's opinions examine AI as a global security and jobs risk, Kerala's new government, India's vulnerabilities within Brics and the valuation challenge in family-business succession.

[Business Standard](#)

GS3 Column | Elephants always have right of way

Putting a fence on a man-made boundary doesn't separate it from the rest of the planet

[The Hindu](#)

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- BRICS 2026: Modi-Xi talks focus on trade, investment and border peace - 'Differences should not become disputes' (International Relations) [Mint](#)
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COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 1 must-know, 1 Prelims facts, 1 in the news, 6 editorials, 0 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Environment & Ecology (2). **Nothing today in** — Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy, International Relations, Social Justice & Welfare, Health, Education, Economy, Agriculture & Allied, Infrastructure & Energy, Science & Technology, Internal Security, Defence, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): nothing today · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: nothing today · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 0 of 8 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 6, Business Standard 2

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